

1948, September 23rd

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original
by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

September 23rd 1948.

Mr. Joseph J. O'Donnell
Page 2

He had never an inclining of the knocks and disappointments still between him and the realization of his goal. Nevertheless, as his calmness of countenance attested while he waited for the undertaker, in exactly the position he had taken for his last long sleep -- with his left foot on the stool, his hand under his head inclined to the same side and his rosary over his shoulder. The Father who was to have the last holy Mass that morning tiptoed in and out, to see the special intention, never dreaming but that Father Guardian was just supplying, as usual, something of the sleep so much of which he was wont to miss during the nights.

Surely his desire to "die in the harness", as he had so often expressed it -- and even about forty hours before, after his solemn Mass in the morning and sermon at Brother Cook's final profession, -- was happily realized. Thanks be to the merciful God. How wonderful in His all ways!

His long experience as superior and the difficulties met with during his whole life, by the grace of God, had fitted him to be a really ideal Father Guardian. Much as I was with him - and I assisted him at his first and second holy Masses - I never but once saw him as really "next to upset"; and that was in connection with something that fell to my duty to execute. I was indignant myself at the very appearance of the situation, as I realized at once that it must appear to him. I surely sympathized with him as I saw him just ready to call me down and as I felt he would be fully justified if appearance had not deceived him. Less than ten words fully satisfied his demand without my even hanging up a long-distance call. The first chance he had afterward, he expressed regret at his manifestation of his weakness. May his dear soul rest with the saints!

Sincerely Yours in +o, Fr. Solanus, O.F.M.Cap.